

Name _____

Class _____

 MARIST SECONDARY SCHOOL DUC IN ALTUM (Aim Higher)	MARIST SECONDARY SCHOOL	
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2025 MALAWI SCHOOL CERTIFICATE OF EDUCATION MOCK II EXAMINATION

AGRICULTURE

(100 marks)

Subject Number: MO12/I

Monday, 3rd June, 2025

Time Allowed: 2 hours

08:00 a.m to 10:00 a.m

PAPER I

Instructions

1. This paper contains 11 printed pages. Please check.
2. The paper contains two sections **A** and **B**. Answer all questions in both section.
3. Answer all questions in the spaces provided.
4. Fill in your name and examination number at the top of each page of the question paper.
5. In the table provided on this page, tick against the question you have answered.

Questions Answered	Tick if Answered	Do not write in this column	
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			
8			
9			
10			
Total			

Section A: 70 marks
Answer all questions in the spaces provided.

- 1. a.** State the two forms of soil degradation.

2 marks

- b.** Briefly explain how a trash line helps to control soil degradation.

2 marks

- c.** State what each of the following soil colours may indicate about a soil.

i. Gray

1 mark

ii. Red

1 mark

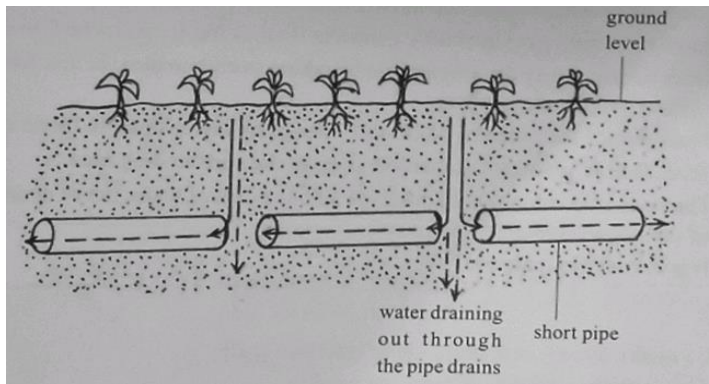
- d.** Describe any two effects of soil salinity on mango production.

2 marks

- e.** List any two ways of modifying acidic soils to suit maize production.

2 marks

2. **Figure 1** is a diagram showing a method of land drainage. Use it to answer the questions that follow.



- a. Identify the method of land drainage.

_____ 1 mark

- b. Mention any two advantages of the method of land drainage mentioned in **2(a)** in sorghum production.

_____ 2 marks

- c. Briefly describe how the following measures help to mitigate the effects of climate change.

- i. Minimum tillage

_____ 2 marks

- ii. Arable -silvo cropping

_____ 2 marks

3. a. A farmer observed a sudden colour change of mycelium from white to green during mushroom fruiting.

- (i) Give any two causes of colour change of the mycelium.

_____ 2 marks

- (ii)** Mention any two ways of controlling the situation.

2 marks

- b.** State any two activities involved in the processing of groundnuts for storage.

2 marks

- c.** Describe the importance of scarification in pasture production.

2 marks

- d.** Explain any two factors that affect the quality of conserved pasture.

4 marks

- 4. a.** Mention any two factors to consider when selecting a site for mango production.

2 marks

- b.** A farmer observed a white powdery growth on leaves, flowers and young fruits of mangoes.

- i.** Identify the disease that attacked the mangoes.

1 mark

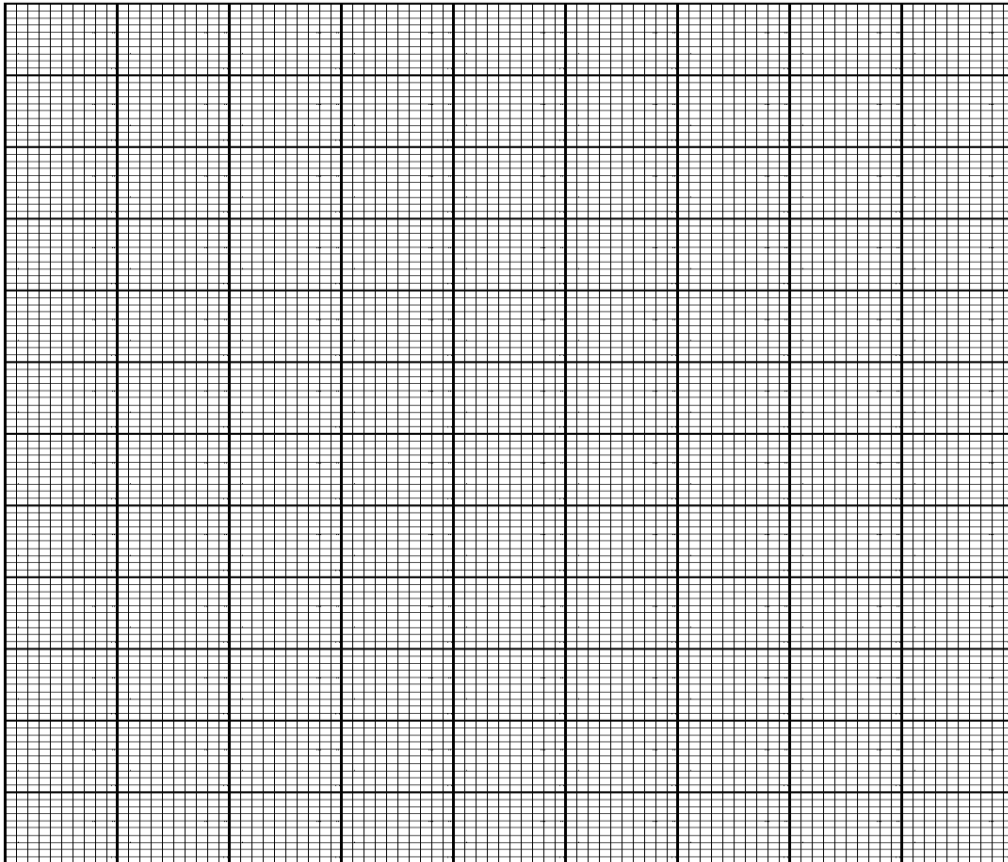
- ii.** State any two mango varieties that are resistant to the disease mentioned in **4(b)i.**

2 marks

5. **Table 1** below shows results of an experiment on production of eggs produced from 50 layers that were exposed to different duration of light.

Duration of light	Number of eggs produced
4	10
8	30
12	50
14	60
20	80
24	80

- a. Plot a graph of number of eggs produced against duration of light.



4 marks

- b. Use the graph to estimate the duration of light required for the chickens to lay 20 eggs.

_____ 1 mark

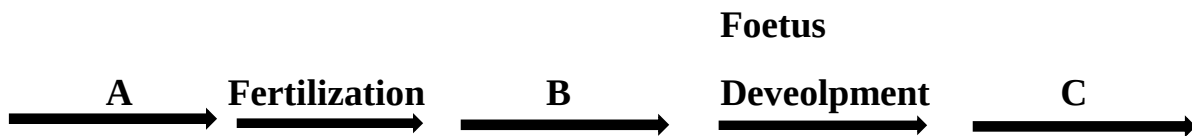
- c. State the economic principle being demonstrated by the graph.

_____ 1 mark

- d. Explain any one importance of the economic principle mentioned in 4(c) in farm business decision making.

_____ 2 marks

6. The flow diagram below shows some processes in the reproduction process of cattle.



- a. Name the processes **A** and **B**.

A. _____

B. _____

2 marks

- b. State any two signs of process **C** in a cow.

2 marks

- c. Classify the following feeds as **roughages** and **concentrates**: fish meal, hay, maize bran, groundnut haulms.

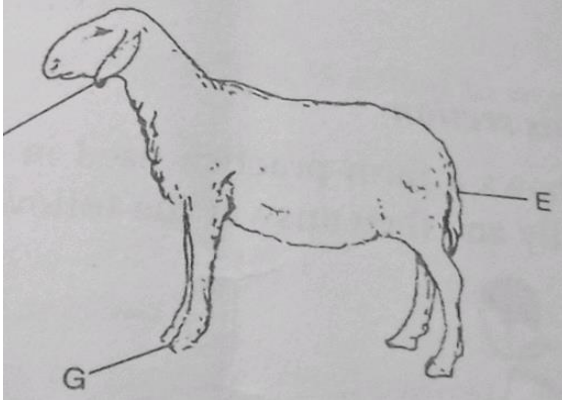
Roughages	Concentrates

4 marks

- d. Distinguish a production ration and a maintenance ration.

2 marks

7. **Figure 2** shows an illustration of a sheep.



- a. State the operations that are carried out on the parts labelled **E** and **G**.

i. **E** _____

ii. **G** _____

2 marks

- b. Give two reasons for carrying out the operation identified at **E**.

2 marks

- c. Name the farm tool that is used in carrying out the operation identified at **G**.

1 mark

- c. What two important variable costs may have been forgotten in the data?

2 marks

9. The following figure shows a farm machinery used on a certain farm.



- a. List any two implements that may be attached to the machinery.

2 marks

- b. Explain any two reasons why the use of the machinery is not fully adopted by most smallholder farmers in Malawi.

4 marks

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11. Discuss any **five** differences between trading and marketing of agricultural commodities.

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